

Google Search Console Implementation & Monitoring Guide

For: IPOReady Production Launch **Date:** 2026-06-01 **Objective:** Verify domain ownership, submit sitemaps, monitor search performance, and establish SEO baselines

Part 1: Domain Verification (Primary Domain)

Domain: ipoready.io

Estimated Time: 5-10 minutes **Verification Methods:** Choose ONE (DNS is recommended)

Option 1: DNS Record (RECOMMENDED)

Best for: Permanent verification with no file hosting required

1. Go to **Google Search Console** → <https://search.google.com/search-console>
2. Select "URL prefix" property type
3. Enter: `https://ipoready.io`
4. Choose "DNS" verification method
5. Copy the TXT record provided (format: `google-site-verification=XXXXXXXXXXXXXXXXXX`)
6. Login to your DNS provider (Vercel, Route53, Cloudflare, etc.)
7. Add new TXT record:
 - **Host/Name:** @ (or leave blank, depending on provider)
 - **Value:** Paste the full Google verification string
 - **TTL:** 3600 (default)
8. Save the DNS record
9. Return to Google Search Console and click "Verify"
10. Wait 24-48 hours for DNS propagation (Google may verify sooner)

Verification Status Check:

```
nslookup -type=TXT ipoready.io
# Should return your google-site-verification TXT record
```

Option 2: HTML File Upload

Best for: Quick temporary verification during setup

1. Download the HTML verification file from Google Search Console
2. Upload to: `https://ipoready.io/google[verification-code].html`
3. Verify that file is publicly accessible
4. Return to Google Search Console and click "Verify"
5. Expected: Verification within seconds to minutes

Option 3: Google Analytics

Best for: If Google Analytics 4 is already configured

1. Connect existing GA4 property in Google Search Console
2. Automatic verification (must have GA4 admin access)
3. No additional steps required

Recommended Approach for IPOReady:

- **Primary:** DNS verification (permanent, most reliable)
- **Backup:** Google Analytics connection (if GA4 already deployed)

Part 2: Subdomain Verification (If Applicable)

Subdomain: www.ipoready.io

Note: If DNS verification is used for root domain (`ipoready.io`), `www` subdomain is automatically verified.

If adding separately:

1. Add property for `https://www.ipoready.io`
2. Use DNS or HTML file verification
3. Create matching DNS record or HTML file
4. Verify in Google Search Console

Canonical Configuration: Ensure root domain (without www) is canonical:

```
<!-- In src/app/layout.tsx (already configured) -->
<link rel="canonical" href="https://ipoready.io" />
```

Part 3: Sitemap Submission

Create Dynamic Sitemap

Location: `src/app/sitemap.ts` (Next.js 14 App Router auto-generates)

Automatic XML Sitemap:

```
https://ipoready.io/sitemap.xml
```

Verify Sitemap Generation:

1. Navigate to `https://ipoready.io/sitemap.xml` in browser
2. Should display XML with `<urlset>` and `<url>` entries
3. Each URL should have:
 - `<loc>` — Full URL
 - `<lastmod>` — Last modification date (ISO 8601)
 - `<changefreq>` — How often page changes (daily, weekly, monthly)
 - `<priority>` — Relative priority (0.0–1.0)

Sitemap Priority Recommendation:

Page Type	Priority	Change Freq
Homepage (/)	1.0	daily
Feature pages (e.g., /features)	0.9	weekly
Pricing (/pricing)	0.8	monthly

Blog posts	0.7	monthly
Support/Docs	0.6	monthly

Submit Sitemap to Google Search Console

1. **Open Google Search Console** → Select `https://ipoready.io` property
2. Navigate to **Sitemaps** (left sidebar, under "Index")
3. Click **"Add/test sitemap"**
4. Enter: `sitemap.xml`
5. Click **"Submit"**
6. Expected: Status changes to "Success" within 24 hours

Monitor Sitemap Health:

- **Submit date** — When you submitted
- **Last read** — When Google last crawled it
- **URLs submitted** — Count from your sitemap
- **URLs indexed** — How many are in Google's index
- **Warnings** — Any parsing issues (should be 0)

Typical Timeline:

-  Submission accepted: Immediate
-  URLs crawled: 24-72 hours
-  URLs indexed: 1-4 weeks (depending on domain authority)

Part 4: Structured Data Validation

Verify JSON-LD Markup in Google Search Console

Already Implemented: Organization, SoftwareApplication, LocalBusiness schemas (in `src/app/layout.tsx`)

Test Structured Data

1. Use Google's Rich Results Test:

- Go to: <https://search.google.com/test/rich-results>
- Paste: `https://ipoready.io`
- Click "Test URL"
- Wait 30 seconds for results

2. Expected Output:

-  Organization schema: Valid
-  SoftwareApplication schema: Valid
-  LocalBusiness schema: Valid
-  No errors
-  Warnings (if any) — review and fix

3. Monitor in Search Console:

- Navigate to **Enhancements** (left sidebar)
- Select **"Structured Data"**

- Filter by schema type:
 - Organization
 - SoftwareApplication
 - LocalBusiness
- View coverage (how many pages have each schema)
- Monitor errors (should be 0)

Common Structured Data Issues & Fixes

Issue	Cause	Fix
Missing required fields	Schema incomplete	Add missing properties (e.g., url, image)
Invalid format (e.g., date)	Wrong data type	Use ISO 8601 format for dates (YYYY-MM-DD)
Orphaned schema	Schema not connected to visible content	Ensure schema reflects page content
Duplicate schemas	Multiple conflicting definitions	Remove duplicate <script> tags

Part 5: Search Performance Baseline

Establish Initial Metrics (Week 1 Post-Launch)

Before Google fully indexes your site, capture baseline data:

What to Record:

Metric	Baseline (Week 1)	Target (Month 3)	Target (Month 6)
Total impressions	TBD	+300%	+600%
Total clicks	TBD	+250%	+500%
Average CTR	—	4-5%	5-7%
Average position	20-50	10-15	5-10
Indexed pages	10-50	50-150	150-300

Baseline Data Capture (Day 1-7):

1. Open Google Search Console
2. Navigate to **Performance** (left sidebar)
3. Set date range to "Last 7 days"
4. Take screenshots of:
 - Queries (top search terms)
 - Pages (top landing pages)
 - Countries (geographic distribution)
 - Devices (mobile vs. desktop)
5. Save or export data for comparison

Export Full Data:

1. Go to **Performance** > "**Date of report**"
 2. Click "**Export**" (top right)
 3. Select "**CSV**" format
 4. Download and archive (baseline comparison)
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Part 6: Ongoing Monitoring Setup

Daily Monitoring (5 minutes)

Monitor These Metrics:

1. **Search Console Dashboard** (<https://search.google.com/search-console>)
 - o Total clicks (trend up or down?)
 - o Total impressions (new queries appearing?)
 - o Coverage status (any new errors?)
2. **Indexed Pages** (left sidebar → Coverage)
 - o Expected: All pages showing as "Indexed" (green)
 - o Watch for: "Excluded" or "Error" entries (red)
3. **Manual Actions** (left sidebar → Security & Manual Actions)
 - o Expected: "No issues detected"
 - o Watch for: Any security or spam warnings

Weekly Monitoring (15 minutes)

Review These Areas:

1. **Top Performing Queries** (Performance tab)
 - o Which keywords drive most traffic?
 - o Are rankings improving?
 - o Any unexpected top queries?
2. **Top Landing Pages** (Performance tab → Pages)
 - o Which pages get most impressions?
 - o Which have best CTR?
 - o Update low-performing pages
3. **Search Analytics by Device**
 - o Mobile vs. Desktop breakdown
 - o Mobile-first indexing impact (should be 60%+ mobile)
4. **New Errors** (Coverage tab)
 - o Any crawl errors?
 - o Any indexing issues?
 - o Any security issues?

Monthly Monitoring (30 minutes)

Full Performance Review:

1. Compare Month-over-Month:

- Total clicks: Up or down?
- Average CTR: Improving?
- Average position: Moving up in rankings?

2. Identify Trends:

- New high-performing keywords
- Keywords losing impressions (why?)
- Pages with declining CTR (improve titles/snippets?)

3. Competitor Benchmarking:

- Search for "IPO software" in Google
- Record positions of competitor sites
- Compare your position vs. competitors

4. Content Opportunity Analysis:

- Which queries have high impressions but low CTR?
- Which have low position (page 2-3 ranking)?
- Create or improve content for these queries

5. Technical SEO Audit:

- Run Core Web Vitals check
- Verify no new crawl errors
- Confirm mobile-friendly rendering

Part 7: Performance Optimization Actions

Improve Click-Through Rate (CTR)

Problem: High impressions but low clicks

Solutions:

1. Improve Title Tags

- Current: "IPOReady — The World's Only Central Hub for IPO Readiness"
- Problem: Too long, gets truncated
- Solution: Shorten to 55-60 characters per query context

2. Enhance Meta Descriptions

- Current: "Manage your entire IPO workflow..."
- Should be: 155-160 characters, include query-relevant keywords, include CTA

3. Test with Google Search Console:

- Use "Performance" tab to see actual titles/descriptions
- A/B test different variations

Improve Average Position

Problem: Ranking on page 2-3, want page 1

Solutions:

1. Internal Linking

- Link from high-authority pages to target pages
- Use keyword-relevant anchor text

2. Content Enhancement

- Add 500+ words to short pages
- Include real examples and case studies
- Update publication date if content is refreshed

3. Backlink Building

- Reach out to finance/VC blogs
- Guest post opportunities
- Mention in relevant publications

Mobile Optimization

Verify Mobile-First Indexing:

1. Open Google Search Console
2. Go to **Enhancements** → **Mobile Usability**
3. Expected: "No issues detected"
4. If issues exist:
 - Fix any reported problems
 - Test in Google's Mobile-Friendly Test (<https://search.google.com/test/mobile-friendly>)
 - Re-submit URL for crawl

Part 8: Troubleshooting Common Issues

Issue: Domain Not Verified After 48 Hours

Symptoms: "Verification pending" or "Verification failed"

Solutions:

1. Check DNS Record:

```
nslookup -type=TXT ipoready.io
```

- Verify the TXT record is present and exact
- Check for typos in verification string
- Wait for DNS TTL to expire (usually 3600 seconds = 1 hour)

2. Check DNS Propagation:

- Use: <https://www.whatsmydns.net/>
- Search for: ipoready.io TXT record
- Wait until showing globally

3. Switch Verification Method:

- Try HTML file upload if DNS fails
- Or try Google Analytics connection

Issue: Sitemap Submitted But Shows "Error"

Symptoms: "Errors found" in sitemap status

Solutions:

1. Validate Sitemap XML:

- Use: <https://www.xml-sitemaps.com/validate-xml-sitemap.html>
- Check for malformed XML

2. Check Sitemap Size:

- Max 50,000 URLs per sitemap
- If over, create multiple sitemaps with sitemap index

3. Verify URLs are Public:

- Click on any URL in sitemap
- Should be publicly accessible (not behind login/paywall)

Issue: URLs Not Indexed After 2 Weeks

Symptoms: Sitemap submitted, but "URLs indexed" showing 0 or very low

Solutions:

1. Request Indexing:

- Use URL Inspection tool in Search Console
- For each URL, click "Request indexing"
- Google will re-crawl within 24 hours

2. Check Robots.txt:

- Verify `robots.txt` is not blocking pages
- Allow all paths: `Disallow:` (empty)

3. Check Meta Robots Tags:

- Verify pages don't have `<meta name="robots" content="noindex" />`
- Should only be on pages you want indexed

4. Increase Internal Links:

- More internal links = faster discovery
- Link from homepage to key pages

Issue: Indexing Crawl Errors

Symptoms: Red errors in "Coverage" tab

Common Errors:

Error	Cause	Fix
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404 Not Found	Page deleted or URL incorrect	Redirect old URLs or delete from sitemap
500 Server Error	Server temporarily unavailable	Check server logs, fix application errors
Redirect error	Too many redirects or redirect loop	Check redirect chain (should be ≤ 2 hops)
Blocked by robots.txt	robots.txt disallows crawling	Update robots.txt to allow crawling

Part 9: Launch Timeline & Checklist

Week 1 (Day of Launch)

- ☐ Verify domain in Google Search Console (DNS method)
- ☐ Generate and test sitemap.xml (navigate to URL)
- ☐ Submit sitemap to Google Search Console
- ☐ Validate structured data (Organization, SoftwareApplication, LocalBusiness)
- ☐ Verify no robots.txt or meta robots blocking indexing
- ☐ Set up Google Analytics 4 (if not already done)
- ☐ Take baseline screenshots of metrics

Week 2-3

- ☐ Monitor domain verification status (should be "Verified")
- ☐ Check that URLs are being crawled (Crawl stats)
- ☐ Monitor coverage for any indexing errors
- ☐ Review top search queries in Search Console
- ☐ Capture week 1 performance baseline

Month 1

- ☐ Google typically indexes homepage within first week
- ☐ Most pages indexed by day 7-14
- ☐ Search traffic should start appearing
- ☐ Compile month-1 performance report
- ☐ Identify top-performing pages and queries

Month 3

- ☐ Evaluate month-3 progress vs. baseline
- ☐ Optimize underperforming pages
- ☐ Build backlinks to improve rankings
- ☐ Plan content updates based on search queries

Part 10: Success Metrics & KPIs

30-Day Targets

Metric	Target
Indexed pages	50+ (from 10 initial)
Total impressions	500+
Total clicks	50-100
Avg CTR	3-5%
Avg position	20-30
Mobile traffic	60%+

90-Day Targets

Metric	Target
Indexed pages	100-150
Total impressions	2,000-3,000
Total clicks	150-250
Avg CTR	5-7%
Avg position	10-15
Branded search share	30%+

180-Day Targets

Metric	Target
Indexed pages	150-250
Total impressions	5,000-8,000
Total clicks	400-600
Avg CTR	6-8%
Avg position	5-10
Non-branded keywords	20+

Part 11: Tools & Resources

Essential Tools (Free)

Tool	Purpose	URL
Google Search Console	Monitor and manage search presence	https://search.google.com/search-console

Google Analytics 4	Track user behavior and conversions	https://analytics.google.com
Google Rich Results Test	Validate structured data	https://search.google.com/test/rich-results
Mobile-Friendly Test	Check mobile optimization	https://search.google.com/test/mobile-friendly
PageSpeed Insights	Monitor Core Web Vitals	https://pagespeed.web.dev

Optional Tools (Paid/Freemium)

Tool	Purpose	Cost
SEMrush	Keyword research, competitor analysis	\$120-500/mo
Ahrefs	Backlink analysis, site audit	\$99-999/mo
Moz Pro	Keyword tracking, site audits	\$99-599/mo
Screaming Frog	Technical SEO audit	\$259/year

Part 12: Quick Reference Checklists

Pre-Launch (Week Before)

[] Domain registered and DNS configured [] SSL certificate active (HTTPS) [] Robots.txt created and correct [] Sitemap.xml generated and tested [] JSON-LD schemas implemented [] Meta descriptions optimized [] Mobile responsiveness verified [] Load speed tested (aim for <3s LCP) [] Google Analytics 4 installed [] Conversion goals defined

Launch Day

[] Verify domain in Google Search Console [] Submit sitemap.xml [] Test URL indexing with Inspect tool [] Monitor for crawl errors [] Share on social media [] Notify team of launch [] Set up monitoring alerts
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First Month

- [] Monitor search impressions daily
 - [] Check for crawl errors daily
 - [] Request indexing for key pages weekly
 - [] Review Search Console reports weekly
 - [] Monitor Core Web Vitals
 - [] Track conversion goals
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Final Notes

Domain: ipoready.io **Launch Date:** 2026-06-01 **Verification Email:** ceo@theupcapital.com **Primary Business Location:** Dubai (Silicon Oasis, UAE) **Secondary Location:** Vancouver, BC (Canada)

Expected Timeline:

- Domain verification: 24-48 hours
- Initial crawling: 24-72 hours
- Full indexing: 2-4 weeks
- First search impressions: 1-2 weeks
- Meaningful traffic volume: 4-8 weeks

Key Success Factor: Consistent, high-quality content and active internal linking will accelerate indexing and improve rankings.